

SENATE No. 2364

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

John J. Cronin

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act to promote commuter rail ridership.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	
<i>John J. Cronin</i>	<i>Worcester and Middlesex</i>	
<i>Vanna Howard</i>	<i>17th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/30/2025</i>
<i>James B. Eldridge</i>	<i>Middlesex and Worcester</i>	<i>2/12/2025</i>
<i>John F. Keenan</i>	<i>Norfolk and Plymouth</i>	<i>2/27/2025</i>
<i>Nick Collins</i>	<i>First Suffolk</i>	<i>5/14/2025</i>

SENATE No. 2364

By Mr. Cronin, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 2364) of John J. Cronin, Vanna Howard, James B. Eldridge and John F. Keenan for legislation to create a fare structure for the MBTA commuter rail designed to increase ridership. Transportation.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act to promote commuter rail ridership.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Chapter 161A of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022 Official
2 Edition, is hereby amended by inserting after Section 52 the following new section:-

3 Section 53. Commuter rail service fares

4 Section 1. The General Manager of the Metropolitan Boston Transit Agency (“MBTA”)
5 shall create fare structure for the MBTA commuter rail designed to increase ridership among
6 residents of transit-oriented areas, including but not limited to the consideration of the following
7 fare structure:

8 (f) A \$10 all-inclusive weekday fare comparable to the existing \$10 weekend and holiday
9 fare;

10 (g) One-way fares not to surpass three times the regular subway fare;

(h) Monthly passes priced for hybrid workers, for example those who commute three days per week rather than five days per week;

(i) Discounts for purchasing multiple rides, for example a 10- or 12-pack;

(j) Reducing the number of commuter rail zones and simplifying overall fare pricing;

(k) Off-setting ticket price reductions with increased parking rates.

Section 2. Within 12 months of enactment, the General Manager of the MBTA shall submit recommendations for these and other possibilities to the Governor and the Legislature, along with estimates for the impact on ridership.

Section 3. Within 24 months of enactment, the General Manager of the MBTA shall execute pilot programs to test the implementation and impact on commuter rail ridership based on the recommendations in section 1.